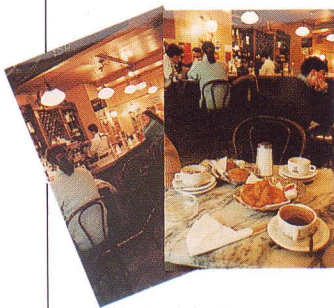




Look for interesting textures and surfaces in familiar scenes

BRUSHWORK EFFECTS

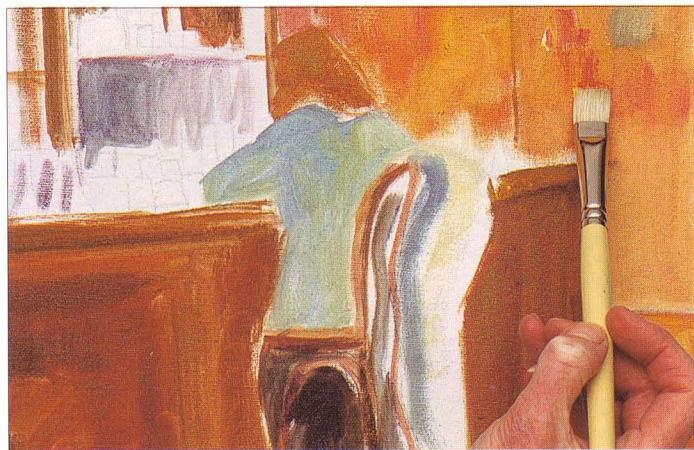
PICKING THE RIGHT BRUSH is part of the skill of effective brushwork, and this choice takes practice. Soft hair brushes are most suitable for smooth effects

and painting intricate work on a small scale. Hog hair or bristle brushes produce more “visible” brushstrokes, manipulating the oil paint into strong, vigorous shapes. Impasted strokes of thick color made with a hog hair

brush can also exploit the rich texture of oil paint and give life to a work. When you paint, the amount of expression that you give to each brushstroke will determine the character and vitality of the work. Try to keep the images big and bold, working economically with large, loose brushstrokes. Remember that if you practice blending, you need to actually disguise individual brushstrokes and fuse the joins between colors and tones in order to create fully modeled images.



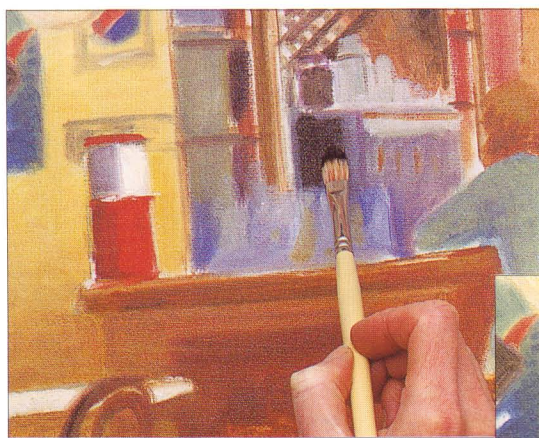
1 Often the most familiar scene or subject matter can reveal interesting textures and surfaces. This café has both rough and smooth surfaces and a strong light that throws some areas into dusky shadows. Sketch the composition in with a large brush, and then block in areas with color and establish patterns using a small or a medium-sized bristle brush and paint thinned with turpentine.



WIPING OFF



The great advantage of oil paint is that it takes a long time to dry, so if you need to get rid of an unwanted brushstroke or color, use a piece of clean cloth to wipe off the mark carefully. Use one end of the cloth dipped in turpentine if you want to wipe the surface completely clean.



2 The first layers of thin paint should dry quite quickly. Drag a medium-sized bristle brush, loaded with color, over the dry surface to give a scumbled effect. The broken color should give the surface greater texture and a deeper tone.

3 Overlay areas in shadow with darker tones. If you need to soften outlines or colors to give smooth gradations in tone or hue, wipe a clean finger over the paint so that the colors mingle gently.

